

ARR RUN-RATE ~\$35M Oct 2025	REV GROWTH 3x+ YoY	CUSTOMERS 100+ enterprise
VALUATION \$4.5B Jan 2026 (Series D)	TOTAL RAISED \$481M	EMPLOYEES 300+

BUSINESS OVERVIEW

PLAIN ENGLISH

- Decagon makes AI 'agents' that talk to a company's customers and actually solve their problems.
- Instead of a dumb chatbot that only answers FAQs, Decagon's AI can do real tasks like issue a refund, cancel a subscription, or reschedule a delivery.
- It works over chat, email, phone, and text, and companies pay mostly only when the AI fully fixes the customer's issue on its own.

THE TECHNICAL VERSION

- Decagon is an enterprise agent platform that orchestrates frontier LLMs (OpenAI, Anthropic, Cohere) plus proprietary fine-tuned models behind natural-language Agent Operating Procedures (AOPs).
- Agents are wired into a customer's ticketing systems, knowledge bases, and operational APIs so they can both reason over context and execute state-changing actions, achieving ~70-75% fully autonomous resolution across voice, chat, email, and SMS. Decagon deploys via a forward-deployed engineering model and monetizes on a per-conversation or higher-value per-resolution (outcome) basis rather than per-seat.

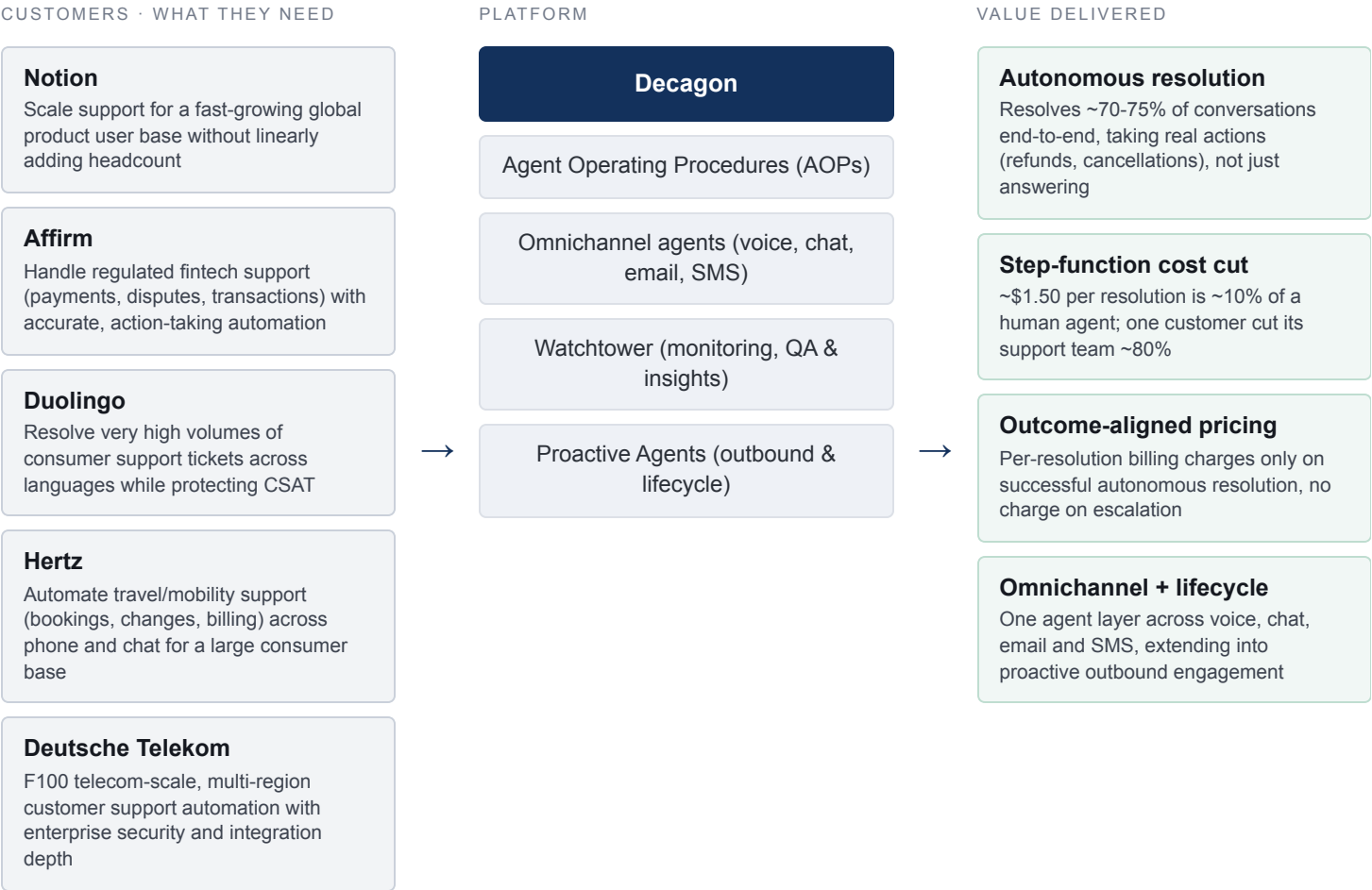
EXPLAINED SIMPLY

- Think of Decagon as hiring a tireless, all-knowing front-desk concierge for a company's customer service, except it's software.
- Like a great concierge, it doesn't just point you to a help page; it picks up the phone or chat, figures out what you need, and handles it (the refund, the cancellation, the rebooking) on the spot, 24/7.
- And the company is billed a bit like tipping the concierge only when the job actually gets done.

- Decagon is a San Francisco-based, AI-native customer-service company founded in August 2023 by Jesse Zhang (CEO) and Ashwin Sreenivas (President) that builds enterprise 'AI concierge' agents.

- Its agents autonomously resolve roughly 70-75% of customer-support conversations end-to-end across voice, chat, email and SMS, taking real actions in backend systems such as refunds, cancellations and disputes rather than just answering questions.
- The product is configured through natural-language Agent Operating Procedures so non-technical CX teams can build and tune agents, and it is deployed via a forward-deployed engineering model with custom integrations per customer.
- Decagon monetizes on consumption, primarily a per-conversation or higher-value per-resolution model of roughly \$1.50 per resolution, about 10% of a human agent's cost.
- ARR scaled more than 3x year over year to about \$35M by October 2025 from roughly \$10M at end-2024, across 100+ enterprise logos including Notion, Duolingo, Affirm, Chime, Rippling, Hertz, Avis and Deutsche Telekom.
- The company has raised about \$481M from a16z, Accel, Bain Capital Ventures, Coatue and Index Ventures, with its valuation tripling from \$1.5B to \$4.5B in roughly seven months via a \$250M Series D in January 2026.
- Decagon sits at the front of the agentic customer-experience category alongside Sierra, which raised \$950M at \$15.8B in May 2026 on similar outcome-based pricing.
- The central debate is durability of the moat: because Decagon orchestrates third-party frontier models, defensibility rests on workflow depth, enterprise integrations and a concierge data flywheel rather than the LLMs themselves.

How the business works, left to right: who buys, what the platform provides, and the payoff.



HOW DECAGON IS DIFFERENT

PLAYER	WHAT THEY MAKE	HOW DECAGON DIFFERS
Sierra	AI customer-experience agents (chat + voice) for large consumer brands (e.g., WeightWatchers, SiriusXM, ADP, Redfin), founded by Bret Taylor; the category's valuation leader (~\$10B on ~\$100M ARR, Oct 2025).	Closest head-to-head rival with nearly identical outcome/per-resolution pricing (~\$1.50/resolution) and forward-deployed model. Decagon's customer base skews more tech-native (Notion, Rippling, Duolingo) versus Sierra's traditional enterprise/consumer brands, and Decagon pushes beyond support into full-lifecycle use (onboarding, feature pitching, lead qualification) via Agent Operating Procedures.
Intercom (Fin)	Incumbent customer-messaging/support platform whose 'Fin' AI agent resolves tickets on top of Intercom's own helpdesk; ~\$343M revenue in 2024.	Intercom is a full support suite where Fin is an add-on tied to its own platform and data; Decagon is a platform-agnostic, integration-led agent layer that sits on top of a customer's existing stack and can even run cooperatively above Intercom as the underlying infrastructure, focused purely on autonomous resolution rather than agent-assist tooling.
Salesforce (Agentforce / Einstein)	Agentforce/Einstein autonomous and assistive AI agents bundled into the Salesforce Service Cloud and CRM platform.	Salesforce sells agents as an attach to its CRM/Service Cloud install base with platform lock-in; Decagon is a best-of-breed standalone with a heavy forward-deployed implementation model, deeper autonomous-action focus (~70-75% full resolution), and pure outcome-based pricing rather than seat/platform licensing.

PLAYER	WHAT THEY MAKE	HOW DECAGON DIFFERS
Ada	AI-powered customer-service automation platform ('AI Agent') focused on multilingual, no-code resolution across chat and messaging channels.	Ada leans self-serve/no-code, broad-channel deflection; Decagon differentiates on enterprise forward-deployed engineering, action-taking against backend systems, and per-resolution economics, targeting complex F100 and high-growth-tech workflows rather than configurable bot deflection.
Forethought	Generative-AI customer-support automation (e.g., 'Autoflows' / SupportGPT) for ticket resolution and agent assistance.	Forethought concentrates on ticket triage, routing, and assist on top of helpdesks; Decagon positions as a fuller autonomous concierge that resolves and acts end-to-end across voice/chat/email/SMS with cross-channel memory, sold on resolutions delivered.
Cresta	AI for contact centers focused on real-time agent assistance, coaching, and conversation intelligence for human reps (and emerging virtual agents).	Cresta's core is augmenting and coaching human agents in the contact center; Decagon's core is replacing the front-line interaction with an autonomous AI agent that resolves the conversation outright, monetized per resolution rather than per seat/agent.

EXECUTIVE LEADERSHIP

CO-FOUNDER & CEO SINCE 2023

Jesse Zhang

Former Google software engineer and Citadel Securities trader who founded social-gaming startup Lowkey (acquired by Niantic in 2021); co-founded Decagon after meeting Sreenivas at an Andreessen Horowitz retreat in Utah.

CO-FOUNDER & PRESIDENT SINCE 2023

Ashwin Sreenivas

Former Palantir deployment strategist who co-founded computer-vision startup Helia (acquired by Scale AI in 2020); earlier sources list his title as CTO, but Decagon's current site lists him as President.

PRODUCT & REVENUE MODEL

- Decagon sells an enterprise AI-agent platform for building, optimizing and scaling customer-facing agents, sold predominantly to large support and CX organizations via a forward-deployed engineering model.

- Agents are defined in natural-language Agent Operating Procedures and wired into ticketing systems, knowledge bases and operational APIs so they can both reason over context and execute state-changing actions.
- The platform is omnichannel across voice (launched via an ElevenLabs partnership), chat, email and SMS, with cross-channel memory.
- The underlying stack is model-agnostic, routing across OpenAI, Anthropic and Google frontier models plus proprietary fine-tunes, with a supervisor model running guardrail checks before responses reach customers.
- Tooling spans Watchtower monitoring, Insights and Reporting, Experiments and Testing/QA, plus Proactive Agents for outbound and lifecycle engagement.
- Revenue is consumption-based: a per-conversation model with volume discounts, or a higher-value per-resolution model that charges only on successful autonomous resolution with no charge on escalation.

RECENT NEWS

2026-05-19

Decagon ranks No. 38 on CNBC's 2026 Disruptor 50 list

SOURCES: [CNBC](#) · [CNBC](#)

Third-party validation from a brand-name list signals Decagon has crossed from hot startup to category bellwether. CNBC pegs cumulative funding at ~\$481M and reiterates 100+ enterprise logos including Avis Budget Group, Block, Deutsche Telekom, Affirm and Chime, useful corroboration of scale for diligence.

2026-03-07

Decagon launches Proactive Agents: outbound voice and cross-channel user memory

SOURCES: [BUSINESS WIRE](#) · [DECAGON](#)

Moves Decagon from reactive deflection (answering inbound tickets) to proactive, revenue-adjacent outreach (outbound calls, callbacks, campaigns) plus persistent customer memory across channels. This expands the TAM beyond cost-center support toward 'agentic commerce' and retention, a deliberate land-and-expand wedge against incumbents.

2026-03-04

Decagon completes first employee tender offer at \$4.5B valuation

SOURCE: [TECHCRUNCH](#)

A tender so soon after the Series D lets 300+ employees take liquidity at the latest mark, a retention lever in a fierce AI talent market and a signal of demand-side investor appetite for secondary exposure. Confirms named logos Avis Budget Group, 1-800-Flowers, Quince, Oura Health and Away, and 100+ enterprise customers.

2026-01-28

Decagon raises \$250M Series D at \$4.5B valuation, led by Coatue and Index Ventures

SOURCES: [BLOOMBERG](#) · [BUSINESS WIRE](#) · [DECAGON](#)

Valuation tripled from \$1.5B to \$4.5B in roughly seven months, one of the steepest mark-ups in 2025-26 AI application software. Crossover-investor lead (Coatue, Index) with a16z, Forerunner and Ribbit following suggests positioning for a late-stage/pre-IPO trajectory and intensifying competition for the customer-experience AI category.

2025-06-23

Decagon raises \$131M Series C at \$1.5B valuation, co-led by Accel and a16z growth

SOURCES: BUSINESS WIRE · FINSMES · DECAGON

The round that minted Decagon's unicorn status and reportedly drew ~5x oversubscription, evidence the AI-concierge thesis was already a competitive funding contest a year before the Series D. Anchors the comp set for valuing AI-native CX vendors against legacy support software.

2025-02-24

Decagon launches Voice agents via partnership with ElevenLabs

SOURCES: ELEVENLABS · DECAGON

Adds the phone channel, the largest and stickiest segment of enterprise support, on top of chat/email, materially expanding addressable spend per customer. Outsourcing the voice model layer to ElevenLabs lets Decagon move fast while keeping its differentiation in the agentic orchestration 'brain', a buy-vs-build choice worth probing on margin and dependency risk.

2024-10-15

Decagon raises \$65M Series B led by Bain Capital Ventures (\$100M total to date)

SOURCES: BUSINESS WIRE · BAIN CAPITAL VENTURES · DECAGON

A ~4x valuation step-up within months of Series A showed early traction was real, not just AI-hype froth. Establishes the rapid round-stacking cadence (A to B to C to D in under two years) that defines Decagon's funding story and stress-tests how durable the underlying ARR growth is.

2024-06-18

Decagon emerges from stealth with \$35M (\$5M seed + \$30M Series A) from a16z and Accel

SOURCES: TECHCRUNCH · VENTUREBEAT · DECAGON

The origin datapoint and the start of the comp ladder; debut logos (Eventbrite, Bilt, Webflow, Substack, Rippling) plus a deep angel roster (Box, Airtable, Okta, Klaviyo founders) gave early credibility that helped compound subsequent rounds. Founding team (Jesse Zhang CEO, Ashwin Sreenivas CTO) confirmed here.

FINANCIALS & KEY METRICS

Reporting period: Private, latest marks & estimates; reported as of Jun 2026. Each metric is tagged with the period it covers; LTM and as-of figures are labeled individually.

ARR RUN-RATE

~\$35M

Oct 2025

REV GROWTH

3x+

YoY

CUSTOMERS

100+

enterprise

TOTAL RAISED

~\$481M

EMPLOYEES

300+

- **AI / Product:** Decagon frames its product not as a single model but as an orchestrated system: Jesse Zhang describes an agent as 'a system of LLMs that are working together,' effectively 'a web of LLM calls or API calls or other logic.' Reliability comes from guardrails, 'a supervisor model or some sort of system' that runs checks before responses go out, and from model-agnostic routing across OpenAI, Anthropic, and Google plus their own fine-tunes, where the intelligence they optimize for is 'instruction following.' The company's core differentiator is Agent Operating Procedures (AOPs): natural-language workflows that compile into structured logic, letting non-technical CX teams 'teach their agents the same way they'd onboard a new teammate.' Decagon now spans voice, chat, email and SMS, noting that voice raises the bar because 'you need the latency to be super crisp.'
- **Demand:** Traction has inflected sharply: ARR/GAAP revenue grew 'more than 3x year over year,' moving from roughly \$10M at end-2024 to about \$35M annualized by October 2025, per Sacra. Decagon added 100+ new global enterprise customers in 2025, with a logo base spanning consumer internet, fintech, travel and commerce, Notion, Duolingo, Rippling, Eventbrite, Chime, Affirm, Hertz, Avis, ClassPass, Oura and 1-800-Flowers.
- **Analyst take:** Decagon sits at the front of the agentic-CX pack alongside Sierra (also ~\$4.5B), with a clean wedge, outcome-aligned, non-technical AOP tooling and a fast-growing blue-chip logo base, but the central debate is durability: as the underlying models it orchestrates commoditize, the moat rests on workflow depth, enterprise integrations and the 'concierge' data flywheel rather than the LLMs themselves. The pricing question is live too: Zhang concedes most customers prefer per-conversation over per-resolution because resolution-based billing creates messy edge cases, which tempers the cleanest 'pay for outcomes' narrative.

KEY RISKS & DEBATES

- ! **Valuation:** the \$4.5B Series D mark is roughly 129x the ~\$35M ARR run-rate, pricing in years of flawless execution and exposed to any compression in AI-application multiples.
- ! **Model commoditization:** Decagon orchestrates third-party frontier models (OpenAI, Anthropic, Google), so the moat must come from workflow depth, integrations and the AOP data flywheel, not the LLMs themselves.
- ! **Incumbent bundling:** Salesforce (Agentforce), Intercom (Fin) and Zendesk can attach good-enough agents to the systems of record and helpdesks customers already pay for.
- ! **Sierra arms race:** the closest peer raised \$950M at \$15.8B in May 2026 on near-identical outcome pricing, escalating the capital, talent and logo contest.
- ! **Pricing tension:** management concedes most customers prefer per-conversation over per-resolution billing, which muddies the clean pay-for-outcomes narrative and complicates ARR quality.

- !

Voice dependency: the phone channel relies on an ElevenLabs partnership, a buy-versus-build choice that raises gross-margin and third-party-dependency questions.
- !

Forward-deployed scaling: heavy custom implementation per customer drives expansion but pressures gross margin and onboarding speed as the logo count grows.

COMPARABLE COMPANIES

COMPANY	CATEGORY	LAST VALUATION	LAST RAISE	NOTE
Decagon	Subject	\$4.5B	\$250M Series D (Jan 2026)	AI support agents; ~\$35M ARR (Oct 2025); 100+ enterprise logos
Sierra	AI agents (CX)	\$15.8B	\$950M Series E (May 2026)	Bret Taylor; closest scaled peer; ~\$100M ARR
Intercom (Fin)	Support SaaS + AI	\$1.3B	\$250M debt (Mar 2026)	Incumbent suite; Fin agent >\$100M ARR; equity mark 2024
Ada	AI customer service	\$1.2B	\$130M Series C (May 2021)	Earlier-gen unicorn; no-code resolution
Gorgias	Ecommerce CX + AI	\$530M	\$30M+ Series C (May 2024)	Shopify-centric helpdesk; ~\$69M ARR
Crescendo	AI + human CX	\$500M	\$50M Oct 2024	Hybrid model; acquired PartnerHero BPO
Cresta	Contact-center AI		\$125M Series D (Nov 2024)	Real-time agent assist + virtual agents
Lorikeet	AI support agents		\$35M Series A (Aug 2025)	Earlier-stage; fintech/complex workflows

SOURCES: Private valuations and rounds from the cited reporting (TechCrunch, Bloomberg, CNBC, Sacra, PitchBook). These are last-round marks, not market prices, and the dates differ by company.

DEMAND SIGNAL · corporate-card spend & adoption, Ramp Data

Decagon is the breakout in AI Support Bots: while incumbents Intercom and Zendesk shed share, Decagon is the only top-5 vendor growing adoption (+6.9% YoY), already holds #3 in category spend, and wins the most customers switching vendors (#1).

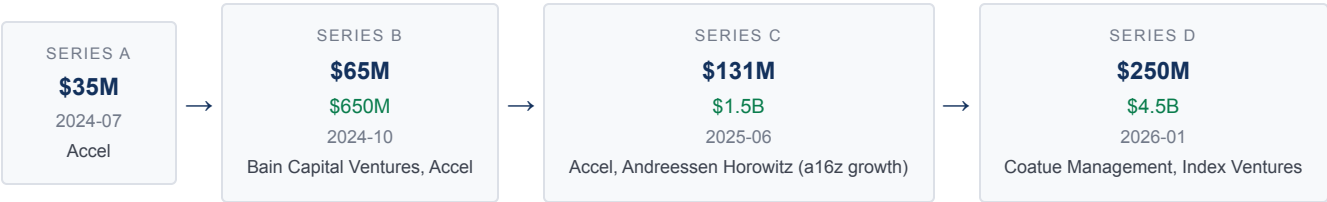
CATEGORY	ADOPTION GROWTH	SPEND SHARE	WIN RATE VS SWITCHERS
AI Support Bots	+6.9%	14.3%	39.4%
Decagon	YoY, only top-5 gainer	#3 in category already	#1, wins most switchers

VENDOR	ADOPTION	SPEND SHARE	ADOPTION YOY	NOTE
Intercom	48.1%	33.7%	-1.6%	leader, share eroding

VENDOR	ADOPTION	SPEND SHARE	ADOPTION YOY	NOTE
Zendesk	15.1%	32.4%	-0.9%	enterprise incumbent
Gorgias	11.4%	4.2%	-3.3%	e-commerce niche, declining
Decagon	10.4%	14.3%	+6.9%	breakout, #1 new-adopter & switch-win
Freshworks	7.7%	6.7%	+0.4%	broad suite

SOURCE: Ramp Data · data as of 2026-04. Decagon is private, this is a demand proxy from buyer card spend, a leading read on traction ahead of disclosed ARR. Ramp's panel is corporate-card spend across 50k+ businesses and skews SMB / mid-market, so it under-captures committed enterprise contracts.

FUNDING HISTORY



Total raised: \$481M

NOTABLE INVESTORS

Andreessen Horowitz (a16z)

Accel

Bain Capital Ventures

Coatue

Index Ventures

Forerunner

Ribbit Capital

IPO READINESS

- Not IPO-ready near term.
- At ~\$35M ARR (Oct 2025) against a \$4.5B private mark (~129x trailing run-rate), Decagon is scaling fast (3x+ YoY) but still an order of magnitude below the typical \$200M-\$500M+ ARR threshold for a software IPO. Even at sustained triple-digit growth, a realistic public-market window is likely 3-5+ years out; expect further private rounds first.
- Heavily VC-funded with strong growth-stage backers (Coatue, Index, a16z, Accel), so no funding pressure forcing an early listing.

SLIDE-READY BULLETS

- 1

Decagon builds enterprise AI agents that autonomously resolve ~70-75% of customer-support conversations end-to-end across voice, chat, email and SMS, taking real actions rather than just answering.
- 2

Outcome-based pricing (~\$1.50 per resolution, ~10% of a human agent) attacks the large labor cost of support; one customer cut its support team ~80%.

- 3 ARR scaled more than 3x YoY to ~\$35M (Oct 2025) from ~\$10M (YE 2024), across 100+ enterprise logos including Notion, Duolingo, Affirm, Hertz and Deutsche Telekom.
- 4 Valuation tripled from \$1.5B to \$4.5B in ~7 months (Series D, Jan 2026, Coatue and Index); ~\$481M raised from a16z, Accel and Bain Capital Ventures.
- 5 Sits at the front of the agentic-CX category alongside Sierra (\$15.8B); the key debate is durability of the moat as the orchestrated LLMs commoditize.

SMART DILIGENCE QUESTIONS

- Q1 Revenue quality: what share of the ~\$35M ARR is per-resolution versus per-conversation versus pilots, and what are net revenue retention and gross margin after third-party model and ElevenLabs voice costs?
 - Q2 Moat: as the underlying LLMs commoditize, what is genuinely defensible (AOP workflow depth, proprietary resolution data, integration lock-in), and how does win-rate hold head-to-head against Salesforce Agentforce and Sierra?
 - Q3 Valuation bridge: what underpins the \$4.5B mark at ~129x run-rate, and how should one read the June 2026 reports of talks near \$4B (primary versus secondary, down-round risk, or reporting noise)?
-

SLIDE KIT

Logo, stats, and copy-paste artifacts

Decagon

SERIES D · \$4.5B

decagon.ai

- AI Customer Service
- Agentic AI
- Enterprise SaaS

COPY-PASTE STATS

Valued at \$4.5B

\$481M total raised

TOP 3 SLIDE BULLETS

- Decagon builds enterprise AI agents that autonomously resolve ~70-75% of customer-support conversations end-to-end across voice, chat, email and SMS, taking real actions rather than just answering.
- Outcome-based pricing (~\$1.50 per resolution, ~10% of a human agent) attacks the large labor cost of support; one customer cut its support team ~80%.
- ARR scaled more than 3x YoY to ~\$35M (Oct 2025) from ~\$10M (YE 2024), across 100+ enterprise logos including Notion, Duolingo, Affirm, Hertz and Deutsche Telekom.

BRAND COLORS

#806AFD #FF6F22 #D499FE #89F1F7 #2B4539

BRAND TAGS

- AI Customer Service
- Agentic AI
- Enterprise SaaS